

2024 JavaScript Rising Stars: Top Projects and Ecosystem Shifts

9th edition • Methodology: GitHub stars added in 2024 across Best of JS curated projects

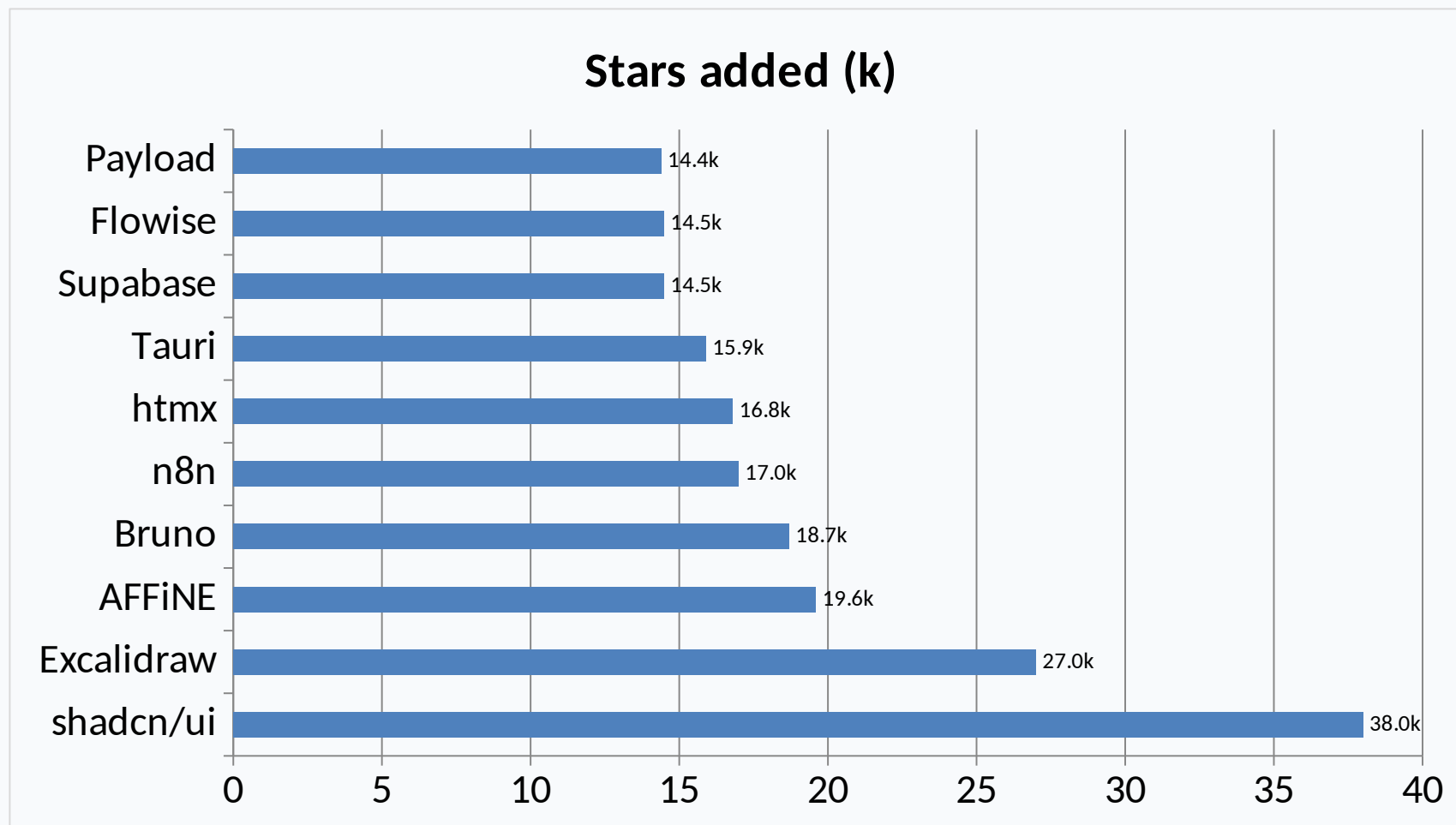
Audience: Frontend engineers and engineering managers

Why this matters: Star momentum signals developer adoption, ecosystem mindshare, and tooling direction

Narrative: Overall leaders → framework shifts → React/Vue ecosystems → 2025 actions

shadcn/ui Leads Overall with +38k Stars, Followed by Excalidraw and AFFiNE

Top 10 projects by stars added in 2024



#1 gap is decisive

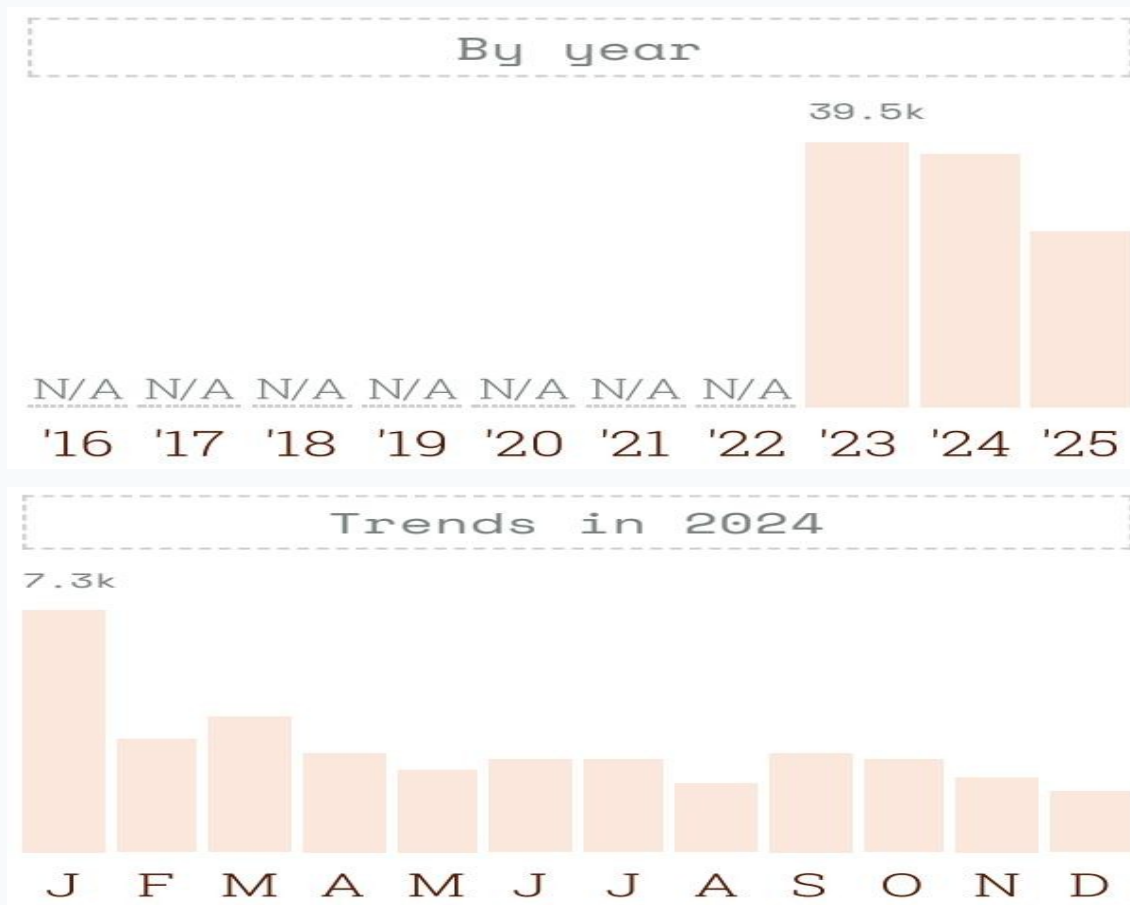
shadcn/ui: +38.0k

vs #2 Excalidraw: +27.0k

Gap: +11.0k stars

adcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for the Second Consecutive Year

77.5k total stars since Jan 2023 • +39.5k (2023) and +38.0k (2024)

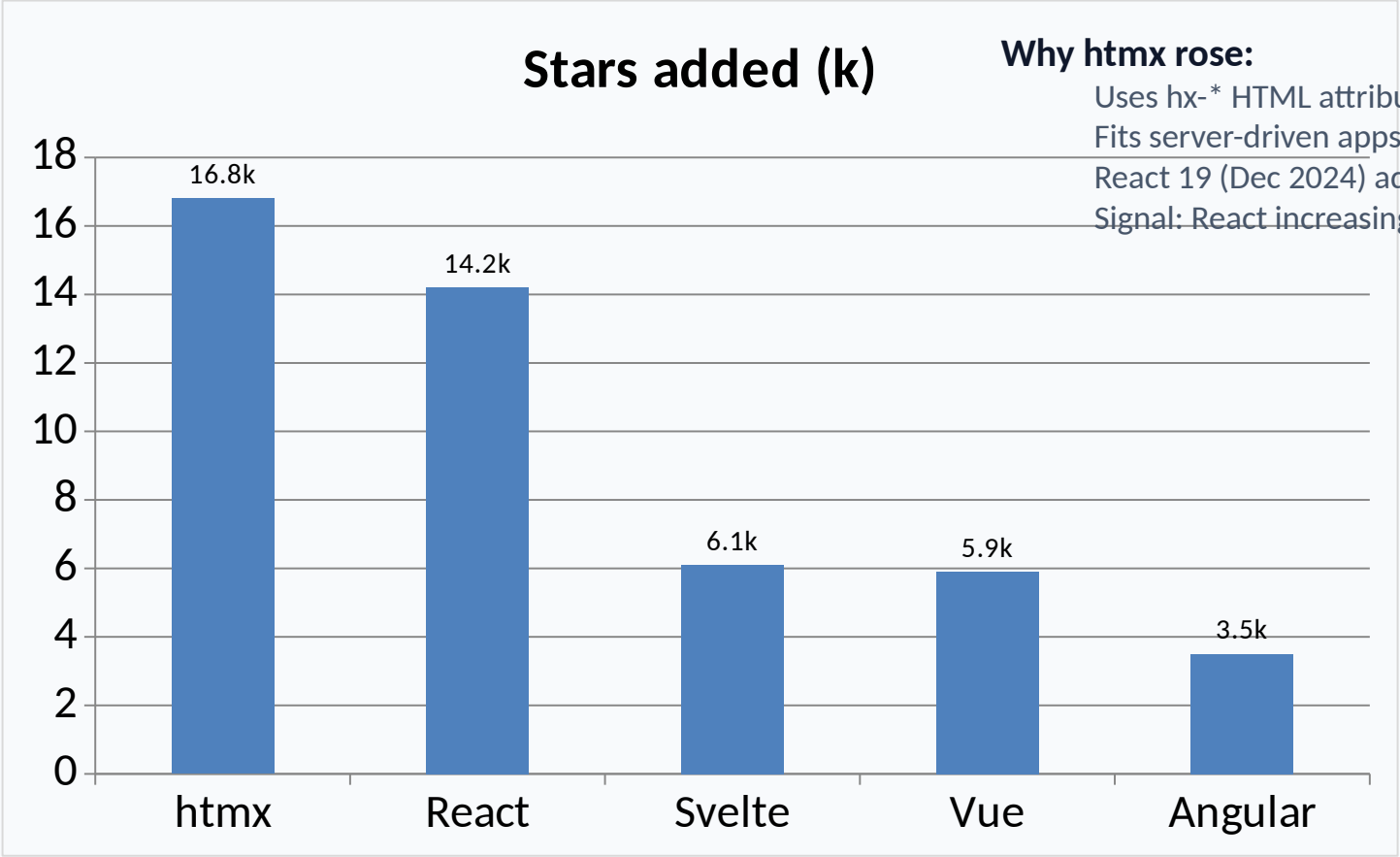


What sustained momentum in 2024:

- Charts powered by Recharts
- Themes with CSS variable generation
- Blocks for common app layouts
- New responsive sidebar component
- Upgraded CLI: Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel, monorepos
- Registry model + v0 integration accelerated ecosystem adoption

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework by Stars Added

Framework stars added in 2024



Why htmx rose:

- Uses hx-* HTML attributes for AJAX/WebSockets
- Fits server-driven apps and progressive enhancement
- React 19 (Dec 2024) added Server Components, Server Functions, Custom Elements support
- Signal: React increasingly behaves like a framework specification

React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate

Top React ecosystem projects by stars added in 2024

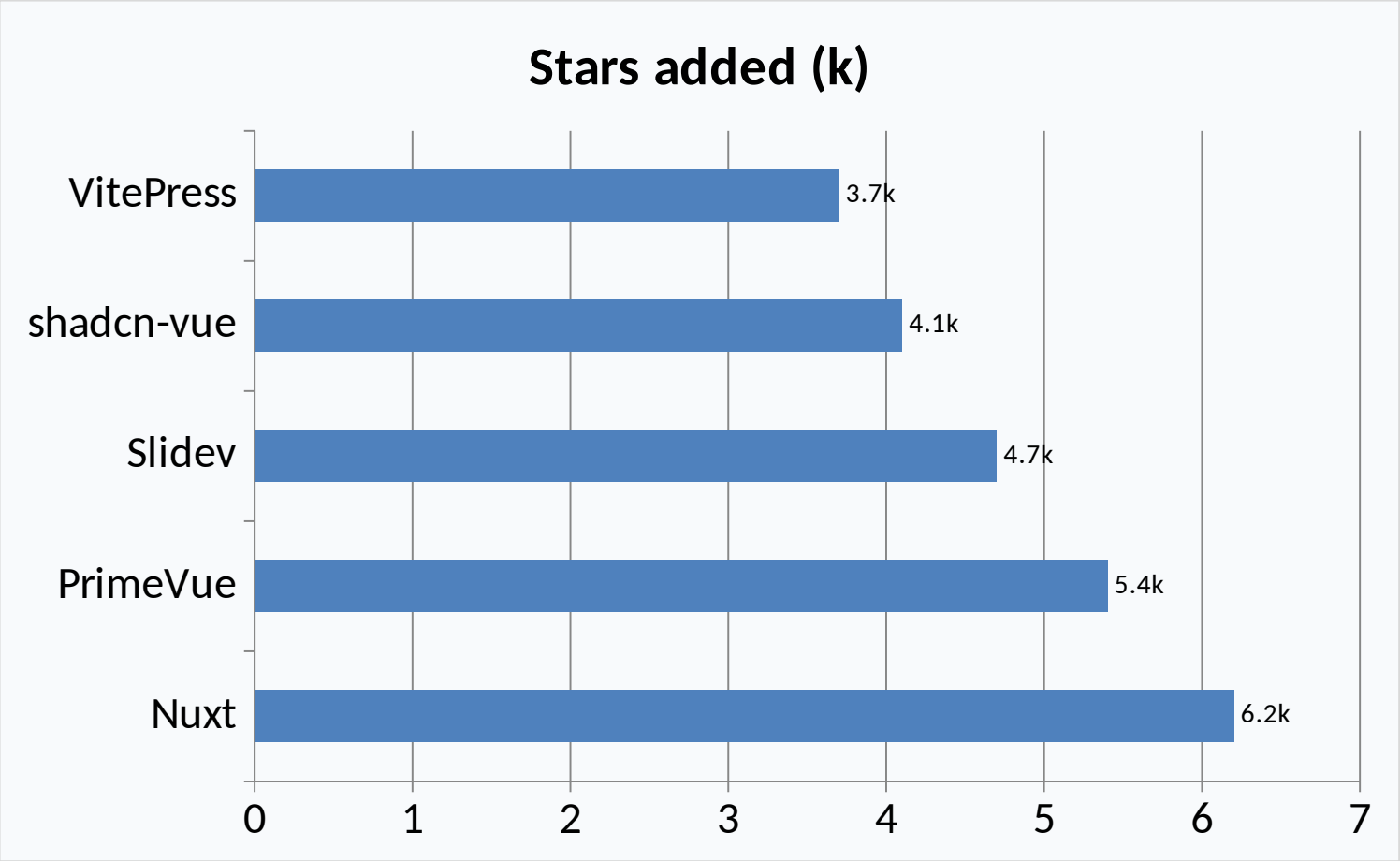
Rank	Project	Stars Added
1	shadcn/ui	+38.0k
2	Excalidraw	+27.0k
3	Payload	+14.4k
4	Magic UI	+13.2k
5	Next.js	+12.1k

Interpretation

React gravity remains strong via ecosystem projects
React 19 pushes server-centric primitives
Frameworks (Next.js, Remix, others) increasingly define implementation details

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth

Top Vue ecosystem projects by stars added in 2024



Ecosystem signals

Vue 3.5 reworked reactivity internals
alien-signals approach landed in
main branch
UI layer strength: PrimeVue +
shadcn-vue growth
Nuxt release cadence reinforces
production confidence

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser-Based Innovation Shape 2024

Cross-cutting momentum beyond traditional frameworks

AI-Native Workflows

n8n +17.0k
Flowise +14.5k
AFFiNE +19.6k
Supabase +14.5k

Desktop & Edge Apps

Tauri +15.9k
Web tech stack for lighter
desktop/mobile apps

Browser as Runtime

PGlite: Postgres in WebAssembly
WebVM: virtual machine in browser

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

Actions for 2025 planning

Actionable guidance heading into 2025

Prioritize component ownership and customization where product velocity matters (shadcn/ui model).
Evaluate HTML-first patterns for server-driven experiences; htmx traction is now material (+16.8k).
Treat React as a framework platform decision, not only a UI library choice (React 19 era).
Budget for AI-native workflows across product and internal tooling; adoption is now baseline.
Track Vue ecosystem bets (Nuxt, PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) as indicators of mature multi-framework strategies.

Bottom line: ecosystem momentum favors pragmatic DX, server-first architecture options, and AI-augmented delivery.